

TechMart Electronics

Official Billing & Customer Support Knowledge Base

Payment Methods | Invoices | Subscriptions | Pricing | Refund
Policy | Billing FAQ

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Prepared by: TechMart Electronics Billing & Finance Operations Team

Classification: Public — for use by customers, support agents, and AI assistants

This document is a fictional company knowledge base created for educational use in an AI/RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) capstone project. TechMart Electronics is not a real company.

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Note: Page numbers above are approximate and correspond to the structure of this knowledge base. This document is intended to be chunked and embedded into a vector database (e.g., FAISS or ChromaDB) for use by the Billing Agent, Technical Support Agent, and FAQ Agent of the Multi-Agent AI Customer Support Assistant.

0. About TechMart Electronics

TechMart Electronics is a mid-sized consumer electronics retailer founded in 2014, headquartered in Austin, Texas, with regional fulfillment centers in Ohio, Nevada, Georgia, and Ontario (Canada). TechMart sells consumer electronics, smart home devices, computing accessories, audio equipment, and home appliances through its e-commerce storefront at www.techmart-electronics.example, its mobile application (TechMart App, available on iOS and Android), and 42 physical retail locations across North America. TechMart also offers a subscription service, TechMart Plus, which provides free shipping, extended warranties, and early access to sales events.

This knowledge base document describes TechMart's billing-related policies and procedures in detail, including how customers pay for products and services, how invoices are generated and corrected, how subscriptions are billed and managed, how products are priced, how refunds and cancellations are processed, and answers to the most common billing questions received by TechMart's customer support team. This document is used to train and ground the Billing Agent within TechMart's AI-powered customer support assistant, and may also be referenced by the Technical Support Agent, Product Agent, and FAQ Agent when a customer question spans multiple domains.

Company Facts

Attribute	Detail
Legal name	TechMart Electronics LLC
Founded	2014, Austin, Texas, USA
Customer support hours	Monday–Saturday, 7:00 AM–11:00 PM CT; Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM CT
Support channels	Live chat, phone (1-800-555-0182), email (support@techmart-electronics.example)
Billing support line	1-800-555-0199 (billing@techmart-electronics.example)
Currencies supported	USD, CAD
Regions served	United States, Canada
Fiscal year	February 1 – January 31
Corporate registration	Delaware, USA; extra-provincial registration in Ontario, Canada

Departments Referenced in This Document

- **Billing & Finance Operations** — manages payment processing, invoicing, and subscription billing.
- **Customer Support** — front-line agents (human and AI) who resolve billing inquiries.
- **Trust & Fraud Prevention** — reviews suspicious transactions and disputed charges.
- **Warranty & Returns** — processes physical product returns, refunds, and warranty claims.
- **Subscriptions Team** — manages the TechMart Plus membership program and its billing cycles.

1. Payment Methods

TechMart Electronics supports a wide range of payment methods across its website, mobile app, and in-store point-of-sale terminals. This chapter describes every accepted payment method, how each is processed, security requirements, regional availability, and how TechMart handles payment failures, holds, and authorization errors.

1.1 Accepted Payment Methods — Online and In-App

1.1.1 Credit and Debit Cards

TechMart accepts Visa, Mastercard, American Express, and Discover credit and debit cards issued by banks in the United States and Canada. Card payments are processed through TechMart's payment gateway partner and are protected using 3-D Secure (3DS2) authentication when required by the issuing bank. Card details are never stored on TechMart's own servers; instead, a tokenized reference is stored so that returning customers can check out faster without re-entering their card number. Customers may save up to five payment cards to their TechMart account under Account Settings > Payment Methods.

When a card is used for the first time, TechMart may place a temporary authorization hold of \$1.00 to \$5.00 to verify that the card is valid and has not been reported lost or stolen. This hold is automatically released within 1–3 business days and does not appear as a charge on the customer's statement, although it may briefly reduce available credit or balance.

1.1.2 Digital Wallets

Customers may pay using Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, and Shop Pay. Digital wallet payments are processed instantly and do not require entry of a card number at checkout, since the wallet provider handles authentication on the customer's device. PayPal purchases may optionally use PayPal Credit where available, subject to PayPal's own credit approval process, which is entirely separate from TechMart's billing systems.

1.1.3 Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL)

For orders between \$50 and \$3,000, customers may choose to split payment into four interest-free installments through TechMart's BNPL partner, PayLater Financial. The first installment is charged at the time of purchase, and the remaining three installments are charged automatically every two weeks to the payment method on file. Missed BNPL installments are subject to PayLater Financial's own late fee policy, not TechMart's; TechMart cannot waive PayLater Financial fees but can assist by providing order documentation for disputes.

1.1.4 Bank Transfers (ACH and Interac e-Transfer)

United States customers may pay via ACH bank transfer for orders over \$500, which is commonly used for bulk or business purchases. ACH payments typically take 2–4 business days to clear, and orders paid by ACH are not shipped until the transfer has fully cleared. Canadian customers may use Interac e-Transfer for orders up to CAD \$5,000; Interac transfers are typically confirmed within a few hours but can take up to one

business day during high-volume periods such as Black Friday.

1.1.5 TechMart Store Credit and Gift Cards

TechMart issues physical and digital gift cards in denominations of \$25, \$50, \$100, and \$250, as well as custom amounts between \$10 and \$500 for digital gift cards purchased online. Store credit is issued automatically when a customer returns an item without a receipt, when a promotional adjustment is applied, or when a refund is issued after the original payment method has expired. Gift cards and store credit never expire and carry no maintenance fees, in compliance with applicable state and provincial gift card regulations. Multiple gift cards may be combined on a single order, and any remaining balance on a partially used gift card stays on the card for future use.

1.1.6 Financing Through TechMart Credit Card

Customers approved for the TechMart Store Credit Card (issued by Comenity-style partner bank, Northgate Bank) may access special financing offers such as "0% APR for 12 months" on purchases over \$299. These offers are subject to the cardholder agreement provided by Northgate Bank at the time of approval; TechMart customer support can explain financing terms but cannot modify APR, credit limits, or approval decisions, which are controlled entirely by Northgate Bank.

1.2 In-Store Payment Methods

At TechMart's 42 physical retail locations, customers may pay using all major credit and debit cards, contactless payments (Apple Pay, Google Pay, Samsung Pay, tap-to-pay debit/credit), cash (U.S. locations only), TechMart gift cards, and the TechMart Store Credit Card. Canadian stores additionally accept Interac Debit at checkout terminals. Cash payments are limited to \$2,000 per transaction as part of TechMart's anti-money-laundering (AML) policy; purchases above this amount must be split across an accepted electronic payment method.

1.3 Payment Security

- All online transactions are encrypted using TLS 1.3.
- TechMart is PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant, the highest tier of payment card industry certification.
- Card numbers are tokenized; TechMart employees, including support agents, can never view a customer's full card number.
- Two-factor authentication (2FA) is required to add or change a saved payment method on an account.
- TechMart's fraud detection system automatically flags transactions with mismatched billing addresses, unusual order volume, or IP addresses inconsistent with the account's shipping history.

1.4 Failed and Declined Payments

When a payment is declined, TechMart displays a generic decline message to the customer and does not reveal the specific reason provided by the bank, since this information is controlled by the issuing bank and not TechMart. Common reasons for declines include insufficient funds, an expired card, an incorrect billing

ZIP/postal code, a card issuer's fraud hold, or the card not being enabled for online ("card-not-present") transactions. Customers experiencing repeated declines are advised to contact their card issuer directly, try an alternate payment method, or verify that their billing address on file with TechMart matches the address on file with their bank.

If a subscription renewal payment fails (see Chapter 3, Subscriptions), TechMart automatically retries the charge on days 1, 3, and 7 after the failed attempt before suspending the subscription. Customers receive an email notification after each failed attempt with a direct link to update their payment method.

1.5 Currency and International Considerations

TechMart charges customers in the currency of their selected storefront: USD for the United States storefront and CAD for the Canadian storefront. TechMart does not currently support checkout in other currencies. Customers using a card issued outside the USD/CAD system may see a foreign transaction fee applied by their card issuer; this fee is set by the issuing bank, not by TechMart, and TechMart cannot refund or waive it.

1.6 Corporate and Purchasing Cards

Business customers frequently pay using corporate purchasing cards (P-Cards) issued by their organization's bank. TechMart's payment gateway supports Level 2 and Level 3 card data, which means purchasing card transactions can include additional line-item detail (tax amount, PO number, item description) required by many corporate expense systems. Business Account holders can enable Level 3 data submission under Account > Business Settings > Purchasing Card Data. Without this setting enabled, TechMart submits standard Level 1 card data only, which may cause a purchasing card to incur a higher interchange fee on the cardholder's end; this fee is set by the card network and issuing bank, not by TechMart.

1.7 Chargebacks and Payment Disputes

A chargeback occurs when a customer disputes a charge directly with their card issuer rather than contacting TechMart first. TechMart strongly encourages customers to contact Billing Support before filing a chargeback, since most billing issues (incorrect charges, undelivered items, subscription confusion) can be resolved faster directly with TechMart, typically within 2-7 business days, versus the 30-90 day timeline typical of a formal card network dispute investigation. When a chargeback is filed, TechMart's Trust & Fraud Prevention team is notified automatically and gathers order, shipping, and delivery evidence to respond to the card issuer within the required response window. Accounts with three or more chargebacks within a 12-month period may be flagged for manual review before future orders are accepted, since a high chargeback rate on TechMart's merchant account can affect processing privileges with its payment partners.

1.8 Managing Saved Payment Methods

Customers can add, remove, or set a default payment method under Account Settings > Payment Methods at any time. Removing a payment method that is currently used for an active subscription prompts the customer to select a replacement method before the removal is confirmed, to avoid an unintended

subscription suspension at the next renewal. Updating an expired card's new expiration date can be done in place for most card networks using automatic card updater services that TechMart's payment partner maintains with major card issuers, meaning many customers never need to manually re-enter a new card number when their physical card is simply reissued with a new expiry date.

1.9 Payment Surges During Sales Events

During major sales events such as TechMart Deal Days (Black Friday–Cyber Monday), transaction volume can increase more than tenfold compared to a typical day. To maintain checkout reliability, TechMart's payment gateway automatically load-balances across multiple redundant processing routes. Customers may occasionally see a brief "Processing your payment..." delay of up to 30 seconds during peak traffic; this is expected behavior and customers are advised not to refresh the page or resubmit payment multiple times, as doing so can occasionally result in a temporary duplicate authorization hold (see the troubleshooting reference below for resolution steps).

1.10 Regional Card Network Notes

Interac Debit, common in Canada, is a domestic debit network and is only accepted at TechMart's in-store point-of-sale terminals in Canada; it cannot be used for online checkout, where Canadian customers should instead use a Visa Debit, Mastercard Debit, or one of the other supported online methods. American Express is accepted both online and in-store in the United States, and in-store only in a subset of Canadian locations due to differing merchant agreements by province.

1.11 Payment Method Troubleshooting Reference

Symptom	Likely Cause	Recommended Action
Card declined at checkout	Insufficient funds, expired card, or bank fraud hold	Try a different card or contact the card issuer
"Billing address mismatch" error	Address on file with TechMart differs from bank's billing address	Update billing address in Account Settings to match bank's
Apple Pay/Google Pay button missing	Device or browser does not support the wallet or card on file	Use another payment method or contact the device's manufacturer
Gift card not applying	Card already redeemed, or a typo in the code	Re-enter the 16-digit code carefully; check balance under Account Settings
ACH/Interac payment pending too long	Bank processing delay, especially near holidays	Allow up to 4 business days before contacting Billing Support
Duplicate charge appears	Temporary authorization hold shown alongside final charge	Hold final charge release in 1–3 business days; contact support if it persists
"Payment method not supported in your region" error	Payment method selected is unavailable in the customer's store location	Switch to a supported method or choose the correct country store

1.12 Mobile App Payment Experience

The TechMart mobile app supports the same payment methods as the website, with a few mobile-specific conveniences. Biometric checkout confirmation (Face ID or fingerprint) can be enabled under App Settings > Security > Biometric Checkout, allowing a saved payment method to be confirmed instantly without re-entering a password, while still requiring the device's own biometric unlock as a security layer. Apple Pay and Google Pay are the fastest checkout options within the app, since the wallet's own device-level

authentication satisfies TechMart's checkout confirmation step entirely, without any additional TechMart password or PIN prompt.

1.13 Accessibility of the Checkout Process

TechMart's checkout flow, on both web and mobile, is built to WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards, including full screen-reader labeling of payment fields, visible focus indicators for keyboard-only navigation, and sufficient color contrast on all error and confirmation messages. Customers who encounter an accessibility barrier during checkout can report it through Account > Help > Accessibility Feedback, which routes directly to TechMart's accessibility engineering team rather than general customer support.

1.14 Adding a Bank Account for ACH Payments

To enable ACH bank transfer as a payment method, a customer links a checking account under Account Settings > Payment Methods > Add Bank Account, providing the bank's routing number and the account number. TechMart verifies the account using an instant verification service where the customer's bank supports it; where instant verification is unavailable, TechMart instead sends two small micro-deposits (each under \$1.00) to the account, which typically appear within 1-2 business days. The customer then confirms the exact micro-deposit amounts under Account Settings > Payment Methods > Verify Bank Account to complete linking. Unverified bank accounts cannot be used for checkout.

1.15 Common Security Questions About Payments

Customers occasionally ask why TechMart requests confirmation of a purchase by email or push notification even after a successful checkout. This is part of TechMart's layered fraud prevention approach: high-value orders, orders shipping to a new address, or orders placed from an unfamiliar device may trigger an additional confirmation step, such as a one-time code sent to the account's verified email or phone number, before the order is finalized for shipment. This step does not delay the payment charge itself in most cases, but may briefly delay order processing until confirmation is received, typically within minutes.

2. Invoices & Billing Statements

This chapter explains how TechMart Electronics generates, delivers, and corrects invoices and receipts for both one-time purchases and recurring subscription charges. It also covers tax handling, invoice formats for business customers, and the dispute process for incorrect invoices.

2.1 What an Invoice Contains

Every TechMart invoice (also referred to as an order receipt for retail purchases) includes the following standard fields: order number, invoice date, customer name and billing address, itemized product list with SKU, quantity, unit price, applicable taxes (sales tax in the US or GST/HST/PST in Canada, as applicable), shipping charges, any discounts or promo codes applied, the payment method used (partially masked, e.g., "Visa ending in 4242"), and the total amount charged. Subscription invoices additionally show the billing period covered (e.g., "March 15, 2026 – April 14, 2026") and the plan name.

2.2 Invoice Delivery

- A PDF invoice/receipt is automatically emailed to the customer's account email within 5 minutes of a successful purchase or subscription renewal.
- All invoices are also stored permanently under Account > Order History > Invoices, downloadable as PDF at any time.
- In-store purchases generate a printed receipt at checkout and an emailed copy if the customer's loyalty account is linked at the register.
- Business customers with a TechMart Business Account may opt into consolidated monthly invoicing rather than per-order invoices.

2.3 Taxes on Invoices

TechMart calculates sales tax based on the shipping address for physical goods and the billing address for digital goods and subscriptions, in accordance with destination-based sales tax rules used by most U.S. states. In Canada, TechMart applies GST, HST, or PST/QST depending on the customer's province, following the applicable provincial tax rules. Tax-exempt organizations (such as registered nonprofits, schools, and government agencies) may submit a valid tax-exemption certificate through Account Settings > Tax Exemption to have future invoices generated without sales tax; approval typically takes 3–5 business days and is not retroactive to past orders.

2.4 Business Invoices and Purchase Orders

TechMart Business Accounts (available for verified companies, schools, and government buyers) may request itemized invoices formatted for accounts-payable processing, including a Purchase Order (PO) number field, a Net-30 payment term option (subject to credit approval), and support for EIN/tax ID display

on the invoice. Net-30 invoices are due 30 calendar days from the invoice date; accounts with invoices unpaid after 45 days are placed on hold and may not place new Net-30 orders until the balance is settled.

2.5 Correcting an Invoice

If a customer identifies an error on an invoice — such as an incorrect tax calculation, a missing discount code, or a duplicate charge — they may request a correction through Account > Order History > Report an Issue, or by contacting Billing Support at 1-800-555-0199. TechMart's Billing Operations team reviews correction requests within 2 business days. If the correction is approved, TechMart issues a **credit memo** referencing the original invoice number, and, if applicable, refunds the difference to the original payment method within 5–7 business days. TechMart does not edit or reissue an original invoice document once generated; instead, a corrected invoice or credit memo is issued alongside the original for audit purposes.

2.6 Invoice Numbering and Reference Format

TechMart invoice numbers follow the format **TM-YYYY-XXXXXXX**, where YYYY is the four-digit year and XXXXXXX is a seven-digit sequential order identifier (for example, TM-2026-0481932). Subscription renewal invoices use the format **TM-SUB-YYYY-XXXXXXX**. Credit memos use the format **TM-CM-YYYY-XXXXXXX** and always reference the original invoice number in the memo body. Customers should provide the full invoice number when contacting support about a specific charge, since it allows the Billing Agent to look up the exact transaction without ambiguity.

2.7 Duplicate and Missing Invoices

If an invoice email does not arrive, TechMart advises customers to check spam or promotions folders first, since automated receipt emails are occasionally filtered by email providers. If the invoice is still not found after 24 hours, customers can always retrieve a copy from Account > Order History, which is the authoritative and always-available source for invoice documents, independent of email delivery issues.

2.8 Sample Invoice Line-Item Breakdown

Field	Example Value
Invoice Number	TM-2026-0481932
Invoice Date	March 14, 2026
Bill To	Jordan Ellis, 118 Maple Street, Austin, TX 78701
Item	TechMart SoundWave Pro Headphones (SKU: TM-AUD-2201)
Quantity	1
Unit Price	\$149.99
Discount	-\$15.00 (Promo Code: SPRING15)
Sales Tax (8.25%, Texas)	\$11.16
Shipping	\$0.00 (TechMart Plus free shipping)

Field	Example Value
Total Charged	\$146.15
Payment Method	Visa ending in 4242

2.9 U.S. Sales Tax Reference by State (Selected States)

TechMart calculates destination-based sales tax automatically at checkout using the shipping address. The table below lists the base state sales tax rate for a representative sample of states; local county and city taxes may apply on top of the state rate shown, and the exact combined rate is always calculated and displayed at checkout before payment is confirmed.

State	Base State Rate	State	Base State Rate
Alabama	4.00%	Montana	0.00% (no state sales tax)
Alaska	0.00% (no state sales tax)	Nebraska	5.50%
Arizona	5.60%	Nevada	6.85%
Arkansas	6.50%	New Hampshire	0.00% (no state sales tax)
California	7.25%	New Jersey	6.625%
Colorado	2.90%	New Mexico	5.125%
Connecticut	6.35%	New York	4.00%
Delaware	0.00% (no state sales tax)	North Carolina	4.75%
Florida	6.00%	North Dakota	5.00%
Georgia	4.00%	Ohio	5.75%
Hawaii	4.00%	Oklahoma	4.50%
Idaho	6.00%	Oregon	0.00% (no state sales tax)
Illinois	6.25%	Pennsylvania	6.00%
Indiana	7.00%	Rhode Island	7.00%
Iowa	6.00%	South Carolina	6.00%
Kansas	6.50%	South Dakota	4.20%
Kentucky	6.00%	Tennessee	7.00%
Louisiana	4.45%	Texas	6.25%
Maine	5.50%	Utah	6.10%
Maryland	6.00%	Vermont	6.00%
Massachusetts	6.25%	Virginia	5.30%
Michigan	6.00%	Washington	6.50%

State	Base State Rate	State	Base State Rate
Minnesota	6.875%	West Virginia	6.00%
Mississippi	7.00%	Wisconsin	5.00%
Missouri	4.225%	Wyoming	4.00%

Local county, city, and special-district taxes are added on top of the base state rate shown above in most states, meaning the combined rate a customer sees at checkout is frequently higher than the base state rate alone. For example, a Texas base rate of 6.25% combined with local Austin-area taxes commonly results in a combined checkout rate near 8.25%. TechMart's checkout always calculates and displays the exact combined rate for the specific delivery address before payment is confirmed, so the table above should be treated as a reference for state-level baselines rather than the final rate charged.

2.10 Canadian Tax Reference by Province

Province	Tax Type	Combined Rate
Ontario	HST	13%
Quebec	GST + QST	5% + 9.975%
British Columbia	GST + PST	5% + 7%
Alberta	GST only	5%
Nova Scotia	HST	14%
Manitoba	GST + PST	5% + 7%
Saskatchewan	GST + PST	5% + 6%
New Brunswick	HST	15%

2.11 Sample Subscription Invoice

The following illustrates a typical TechMart Plus subscription renewal invoice.

Field	Example Value
Invoice Number	TM-SUB-2026-0091254
Invoice Date	May 15, 2026
Plan	TechMart Plus Pro — Monthly
Billing Period	May 15, 2026 – June 14, 2026
Base Price	\$19.99
Tax (8.25%, Texas)	\$1.65
Total Charged	\$21.64
Payment Method	Mastercard ending in 7788

Field	Example Value
Next Renewal Date	June 15, 2026

2.12 Sample Credit Memo

A credit memo is issued when TechMart corrects a billing error after the original invoice has already been generated. It always references the original invoice and clearly states the reason for the adjustment.

Field	Example Value
Credit Memo Number	TM-CM-2026-0481932
References Original Invoice	TM-2026-0481932
Reason	Sales tax recalculated after billing address correction
Credit Amount	-\$3.42
Refund Method	Original payment method (Visa ending in 4242)
Processing Time	5–7 business days

2.13 Invoice Retention and Data Access

TechMart retains invoice and order history data for a minimum of 7 years to satisfy tax and financial record-keeping obligations in both the United States and Canada. Customers can access their full order and invoice history for as long as their account remains active. Customers who close their TechMart account may request a full export of their historical invoices before closure by contacting billing@techmart-electronics.example; TechMart provides this export within 10 business days as required under applicable consumer data access regulations.

2.14 Disputing an Invoice — Step by Step

- Step 1 — Locate the invoice number in question under Account > Order History.
- Step 2 — Select Report an Issue and choose the category that best matches the discrepancy (tax, discount, duplicate charge, incorrect item, other).
- Step 3 — Provide a brief description; screenshots are optional but speed up review.
- Step 4 — Billing Operations reviews the request, typically within 2 business days.
- Step 5 — If approved, a credit memo is issued and, where applicable, a refund of the difference is sent to the original payment method within 5–7 business days.
- Step 6 — If the request is denied, the customer receives a written explanation and may escalate to a Billing Support supervisor for a secondary review.

2.15 Sample Automated Billing Email Templates

The following are representative examples of the automated billing emails TechMart sends to customers. These templates are provided here so that the AI Billing Agent can recognize and explain the content of these notifications if a customer asks about an email they received.

2.15.1 Payment Receipt Email

Subject: Your TechMart Electronics receipt — Order TM-2026-0481932

Body summary: confirms the order number, itemized purchase, total amount charged, the last four digits of the payment method used, estimated delivery date, and a link to Order History. Ends with Billing Support contact information.

2.15.2 Subscription Renewal Reminder Email (Annual Plans Only)

Subject: Your TechMart Plus membership renews in 3 days

Body summary: states the plan name, renewal date, renewal price, and the payment method that will be charged, along with a direct link to change or cancel the plan before the renewal date.

2.15.3 Payment Failed Email

Subject: We couldn't process your TechMart payment

Body summary: explains that a charge attempt failed, states which attempt number this is (1 of 3, 2 of 3, or 3 of 3), and provides a direct link to update the payment method before the next automatic retry or before benefits are suspended.

2.15.4 Refund Confirmation Email

Subject: Your TechMart refund has been processed

Body summary: confirms the refunded amount, the original order or invoice number, the refund method (original payment method or store credit), and the expected posting timeframe.

2.15.5 Credit Memo Notification Email

Subject: A correction has been applied to your TechMart invoice

Body summary: references the original invoice number, states the reason for the correction in plain language, and shows the adjusted amount along with a link to download the credit memo PDF.

2.16 Invoice-Related Data Fields Reference

Field Name	Description
order_id	Unique identifier for the order, matches the invoice number without the TM- prefix
invoice_number	Full formatted invoice identifier, e.g. TM-2026-0481932
billing_period_start / end	Applicable only to subscription invoices; defines the covered service dates
line_items[]	Array of purchased items, each with SKU, description, quantity, and unit price
tax_breakdown	Itemized tax amounts by tax type (state/provincial, local, GST/HST/PST)
payment_method_display	Masked payment method description shown to the customer
total_charged	Final amount charged to the customer, inclusive of tax and shipping, net of discounts

Field Name	Description
credit_memo_refs[]	List of any credit memo numbers that reference this invoice

3. Subscriptions & Membership Plans

TechMart Electronics offers a paid membership program, **TechMart Plus**, along with several product-attached subscription services. This chapter describes every subscription offering, billing cycles, proration rules, plan changes, trials, and cancellation mechanics.

3.1 TechMart Plus Membership

3.1.1 Plan Tiers

Plan	Monthly Price	Annual Price	Key Benefits
TechMart Plus Basic	\$7.99/mo	\$79.00/yr (save 17%)	Free standard shipping, member-only pricing, 90-
TechMart Plus Family	\$12.99/mo	\$129.00/yr (save 17%)	All Basic benefits shared across up to 5 linked acco
TechMart Plus Pro	\$19.99/mo	\$199.00/yr (save 17%)	All Family benefits, plus free 2-day shipping, exte

3.1.2 Billing Cycle

TechMart Plus is billed either monthly or annually, based on the plan selected at signup. The renewal date is set to the calendar day of the original signup (for example, a membership started on the 15th renews on the 15th of each subsequent month). If a renewal date falls on a day that does not exist in a given month (such as the 31st in a 30-day month), the charge occurs on the last day of that month instead.

3.1.3 Free Trial

New customers are eligible for a 30-day free trial of TechMart Plus Pro. No charge occurs during the trial period. Three days before the trial ends, TechMart sends a reminder email. If the customer does not cancel before the trial ends, the account automatically converts to a paid TechMart Plus Pro monthly subscription and the first charge occurs on day 31. A customer may use the free trial only once per account and once per payment method; TechMart's fraud system flags repeated trial signups using the same card across multiple accounts.

3.1.4 Upgrading and Downgrading

Customers may change tiers at any time from Account > Membership > Change Plan. Upgrades (e.g., Basic to Pro) take effect immediately, and TechMart charges a prorated amount for the remainder of the current billing cycle, calculated as the difference between the new and old plan price multiplied by the fraction of the cycle remaining. Downgrades (e.g., Pro to Basic) take effect at the start of the next billing cycle; no partial refund is issued for the difference in the current cycle, since the customer already received the higher tier's benefits for that period.

3.1.5 Pausing a Membership

TechMart Plus Pro and Family members may pause their membership for up to 3 months per calendar year instead of cancelling outright. While paused, no charges occur and Plus-exclusive benefits are unavailable.

At the end of the pause period, billing resumes automatically at the previously selected plan and price, unless the customer cancels before resumption.

3.2 Product-Attached Subscriptions

3.2.1 TechMart SmartHome Cloud

Customers who purchase TechMart smart home cameras, video doorbells, or smart locks may subscribe to SmartHome Cloud for continuous video recording history, starting at \$3.99/month for 7-day history per device, or \$9.99/month for 30-day history covering up to 5 devices. SmartHome Cloud is billed monthly only; there is no annual plan. The first 14 days are free for customers who register a new compatible device.

3.2.2 TechMart Warranty+ Auto-Renew Plans

Extended warranty coverage purchased at checkout (see Chapter 5 for full warranty and refund terms) may include an optional auto-renewing annual plan for ongoing accidental damage protection on major appliances, priced at 8% of the original product price per year, billed on the anniversary of the original purchase date.

3.2.3 TechMart Streaming Bundle

Customers who purchase a TechMart Vision smart TV may add the TechMart Streaming Bundle, which provides one year of complimentary access to a curated selection of partner streaming apps pre-loaded on the device. This is a one-time promotional benefit, not a recurring TechMart charge; after 12 months, customers are billed directly by the individual streaming providers if they choose to continue, and TechMart is not involved in that billing relationship.

3.3 Failed Subscription Payments

If a subscription renewal charge fails, TechMart retries automatically on day 1, day 3, and day 7 after the failed attempt, using the same payment method on file. If all three retries fail, the subscription enters a 7-day grace period during which Plus benefits remain active, followed by automatic suspension if payment is still not received. Suspended TechMart Plus memberships can be reactivated at any time by updating the payment method; no benefits are lost permanently, and any membership pricing lock-ins from a prior annual plan are preserved for 30 days after suspension.

3.4 Cancelling a Subscription

Subscriptions can be cancelled at any time from Account > Membership > Manage Subscription > Cancel, through live chat, or by phone. TechMart does not require customers to provide a reason for cancellation, although an optional exit survey is presented. Cancellation takes effect at the end of the current paid billing cycle; TechMart does not offer partial-period refunds for early cancellation of monthly plans. Annual plan cancellations follow the prorated refund rules described in Chapter 5, Section 5.4.

3.5 Subscription Notifications

- Renewal reminder email sent 3 days before every annual renewal (not sent for monthly renewals).

- Payment receipt email sent immediately after every successful renewal charge.
- Failed payment email sent after each of the three retry attempts.
- Suspension notice email sent if all retries fail and the grace period expires.
- Plan change confirmation email sent immediately after any upgrade, downgrade, or pause action.

3.6 Subscription Billing Cycle Reference

Subscription	Billing Frequency	Trial Available	Cancellation Effective
TechMart Plus Basic	Monthly or Annual	No	End of current cycle
TechMart Plus Family	Monthly or Annual	No	End of current cycle
TechMart Plus Pro	Monthly or Annual	Yes, 30 days	End of current cycle
SmartHome Cloud (7-day)	Monthly only	Yes, 14 days (new device)	End of current cycle
SmartHome Cloud (30-day)	Monthly only	Yes, 14 days (new device)	End of current cycle
Warranty+ Auto-Renew	Annual	No	Effective immediately upon request

3.7 Worked Proration Example

Consider a customer on TechMart Plus Basic (\$7.99/month), 10 days into a 30-day billing cycle, who upgrades to TechMart Plus Pro (\$19.99/month). The price difference is \$12.00/month. With 20 days remaining in the cycle (20/30 of the month), the prorated upgrade charge is calculated as $\$12.00 \times (20/30) = \8.00 , charged immediately at the time of upgrade. The customer's next full renewal, 20 days later, will then charge the full \$19.99 Pro price going forward. This same proration formula — (price difference) $\times$ (days remaining $\div$ days in cycle) — is used for all mid-cycle upgrades across every TechMart subscription product.

3.8 Family Plan Account Linking

TechMart Plus Family allows the primary subscriber to invite up to 4 additional members by email invitation from Account > Membership > Family Members. Invited members receive full Plus benefits (free shipping, member pricing, extended returns) on their own separate TechMart accounts without needing their own payment method on file for the membership itself, although they still use their own payment method for their individual product purchases. Only the primary subscriber is billed for the Family plan; removing a family member from the plan is done by the primary subscriber at any time and takes effect immediately, though the removed member's own past purchases and order history remain on their individual account.

3.9 Enterprise and Education Subscription Pricing

Verified TechMart Business Accounts with 10 or more employees may qualify for TechMart Plus Business, a volume-priced variant of TechMart Plus Pro starting at \$14.99 per seat per month for 10-49 seats, \$12.99 per seat per month for 50-199 seats, and custom pricing for 200+ seats, billed monthly via a single consolidated invoice to the organization rather than individual member cards. Verified K-12 schools and

higher-education institutions receive a standard 20% discount off TechMart Plus Business pricing upon submission of a valid education verification document.

3.10 Subscription Data and Privacy

Billing data associated with subscriptions — including plan history, payment method tokens, and renewal dates — is retained for the lifetime of the account plus 7 years after cancellation, consistent with TechMart's financial record-keeping obligations described in Section 2.13. Customers may request a copy of their subscription billing history at any time through Account > Privacy > Download My Data.

3.11 Subscription Lifecycle Summary

- **Signup** — customer selects a plan and billing frequency; trial begins immediately if eligible.
- **Active** — subscription renews automatically each cycle on the anniversary billing date.
- **Payment Failed** — up to three automatic retries occur over 7 days.
- **Grace Period** — 7 additional days with benefits still active while the customer updates payment.
- **Suspended** — benefits paused; reactivation is available at any time by updating payment.
- **Cancelled** — no further renewals; access continues until the end of the already-paid period.
- **Reactivated** — a cancelled or suspended customer may resubscribe at any time, at current pricing.

4. Product Pricing & Catalog

This chapter documents TechMart Electronics' pricing structure, including standard catalog pricing across major product categories, discount and promotional pricing rules, price-match policy, and regional pricing differences between the United States and Canada.

4.1 Pricing Principles

- All prices are listed in the currency of the customer's selected storefront (USD or CAD) and exclude tax unless stated otherwise.
- Prices may vary between the U.S. and Canadian storefronts due to differing import duties, currency conversion, and regional supplier agreements.
- TechMart reviews and may adjust prices at any time; the price shown at the moment of checkout is the price charged, regardless of price changes shown afterward.
- Clearance and open-box items are marked with a distinct badge and are typically final sale (see Chapter 5, Section 5.6).

4.2 Product Catalog — Representative Pricing by Category

4.2.1 Audio Products

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-AUD-2201	SoundWave Pro Headphones (Over-Ear, ANC)	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-AUD-2202	SoundWave Air Earbuds	\$79.99	\$104.99
TM-AUD-2210	BassCube Portable Speaker	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-AUD-2215	BassCube Max Home Speaker	\$189.99	\$246.99
TM-AUD-2230	StageMic USB Condenser Microphone	\$99.99	\$129.99

4.2.2 Computing Accessories

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-PC-3301	TypeFlow Mechanical Keyboard	\$89.99	\$116.99
TM-PC-3305	GlidePoint Wireless Mouse	\$34.99	\$45.99
TM-PC-3312	PowerDock 12-in-1 USB-C Hub	\$64.99	\$84.99
TM-PC-3320	ClearView 27-inch 4K Monitor	\$329.99	\$429.99
TM-PC-3325	ClearView 34-inch Ultrawide Monitor	\$549.99	\$714.99
TM-PC-3340	ChargeAll 100W GaN Charger	\$44.99	\$58.99

4.2.3 Smart Home

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-SH-4401	GuardCam Outdoor Security Camera	\$89.99	\$116.99
TM-SH-4405	GuardCam Video Doorbell	\$119.99	\$155.99
TM-SH-4410	SmartLock Pro Deadbolt	\$179.99	\$233.99
TM-SH-4420	ClimateSense Smart Thermostat	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-SH-4430	HomeHub Central Controller	\$129.99	\$168.99

4.2.4 Televisions and Displays

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-TV-5501	TechMart Vision 43-inch 4K Smart TV	\$329.99	\$429.99
TM-TV-5505	TechMart Vision 55-inch 4K Smart TV	\$499.99	\$649.99
TM-TV-5510	TechMart Vision 65-inch QLED Smart TV	\$799.99	\$1,039.99
TM-TV-5520	TechMart Vision 75-inch QLED Smart TV	\$1,299.99	\$1,689.99

4.2.5 Major Appliances

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-AP-6601	FreshKeep 22 cu.ft. French Door Refrigerator	\$1,499.99	\$1,949.99
TM-AP-6610	QuickWash Front-Load Washing Machine	\$799.99	\$1,039.99
TM-AP-6615	QuickWash Dryer (Electric)	\$699.99	\$909.99
TM-AP-6620	EvenHeat Convection Range	\$899.99	\$1,169.99
TM-AP-6630	SilentClean Dishwasher	\$649.99	\$844.99

4.2.6 Gaming

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-GM-7701	ArenaPad Pro Gaming Controller	\$69.99	\$90.99
TM-GM-7705	ArenaPad Wireless Racing Wheel	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-GM-7710	PulseSeat Gaming Chair	\$249.99	\$324.99
TM-GM-7715	FrameRate 27-inch 165Hz Gaming Monitor	\$279.99	\$364.99
TM-GM-7720	NightVision RGB Gaming Headset	\$89.99	\$116.99
TM-GM-7725	VaultDrive 2TB External Gaming SSD	\$159.99	\$208.99

4.2.7 Wearables

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-WR-8801	PulseFit Smartwatch Series 3	\$199.99	\$259.99
TM-WR-8805	PulseFit Smartwatch SE	\$129.99	\$168.99
TM-WR-8810	TrackBand Fitness Tracker	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-WR-8815	PulseFit Kids Watch	\$79.99	\$104.99

4.2.8 Cameras and Drones

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-CAM-9901	CaptureOne Mirrorless Camera Body	\$899.99	\$1,169.99
TM-CAM-9905	CaptureOne 18-55mm Kit Lens	\$249.99	\$324.99
TM-CAM-9910	ActionGo Waterproof Action Camera	\$179.99	\$233.99
TM-CAM-9920	SkyView Foldable Camera Drone	\$549.99	\$714.99
TM-CAM-9925	SkyView Mini Drone	\$199.99	\$259.99

4.2.9 Tablets, E-Readers, and Laptops

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-TAB-1001	SlateBook 11-inch Tablet, 128GB	\$329.99	\$429.99
TM-TAB-1005	SlateBook Pro 13-inch Tablet, 256GB	\$599.99	\$779.99
TM-TAB-1010	PageTurn E-Reader, 8GB	\$99.99	\$129.99
TM-LAP-1101	AeroBook 14-inch Laptop, 512GB SSD	\$799.99	\$1,039.99
TM-LAP-1105	AeroBook Pro 16-inch Laptop, 1TB SSD	\$1,299.99	\$1,689.99
TM-LAP-1110	WorkStation Mini Desktop PC	\$649.99	\$844.99

4.2.10 Car Electronics

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-CAR-1201	DriveLink Wireless CarPlay Adapter	\$79.99	\$104.99
TM-CAR-1205	DriveLink Dash Cam, Dual Channel	\$129.99	\$168.99
TM-CAR-1210	ChargeFast Car Charger, 65W	\$29.99	\$38.99
TM-CAR-1215	SafeView Backup Camera Kit	\$89.99	\$116.99

4.2.11 Small Kitchen Appliances

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-KIT-1301	BrewMaster Drip Coffee Maker	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-KIT-1305	BrewMaster Espresso Machine	\$249.99	\$324.99
TM-KIT-1310	AirCrisp XL Air Fryer	\$119.99	\$155.99
TM-KIT-1315	BlendPro High-Speed Blender	\$89.99	\$116.99
TM-KIT-1320	InstaCook Multi-Cooker, 8-Quart	\$99.99	\$129.99
TM-KIT-1325	ToastEven 4-Slice Toaster	\$44.99	\$58.99

4.2.12 Personal Care Electronics

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-PC2-1401	SmoothGlide Electric Shaver	\$69.99	\$90.99
TM-PC2-1405	SmoothGlide Hair Trimmer Kit	\$44.99	\$58.99
TM-PC2-1410	AirFlow Ionic Hair Dryer	\$54.99	\$71.99
TM-PC2-1415	BrightSmile Electric Toothbrush	\$39.99	\$51.99

4.2.13 Networking and Home Office

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-NET-1501	MeshLink Wi-Fi 6 Router	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-NET-1505	MeshLink 3-Pack Whole-Home Mesh System	\$299.99	\$389.99
TM-NET-1510	SignalBoost Wi-Fi Extender	\$49.99	\$64.99
TM-OFF-1601	PrintFast All-in-One Inkjet Printer	\$129.99	\$168.99
TM-OFF-1605	PrintFast Laser Printer	\$219.99	\$285.99
TM-OFF-1610	DeskView Adjustable Monitor Arm	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-OFF-1615	ErgoRise Standing Desk Converter	\$189.99	\$246.99

4.2.14 Robot Vacuums and Home Cleaning

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-CLN-1701	SweepBot 2000 Robot Vacuum	\$249.99	\$324.99
TM-CLN-1705	SweepBot 3000 Vacuum & Mop Combo	\$399.99	\$519.99
TM-CLN-1710	SweepBot Self-Empty Base Add-On	\$129.99	\$168.99
TM-CLN-1715	AirPure HEPA Air Purifier, Large Room	\$179.99	\$233.99

4.2.15 Smart Lighting

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-LGT-1801	GlowSet Smart Bulb, 4-Pack	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-LGT-1805	GlowStrip LED Light Strip, 16ft	\$39.99	\$51.99
TM-LGT-1810	GlowSwitch Smart Dimmer Switch	\$29.99	\$38.99
TM-LGT-1815	GlowSet Outdoor Smart Floodlight	\$49.99	\$64.99

4.2.16 Home Security Systems

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-SEC-1901	GuardSuite Starter Security Kit	\$249.99	\$324.99
TM-SEC-1905	GuardSuite Window/Door Sensor, 4-Pack	\$49.99	\$64.99
TM-SEC-1910	GuardSuite Motion Sensor	\$29.99	\$38.99
TM-SEC-1915	GuardSuite Professional Monitoring (see Ch. 3)	\$14.99/mo	\$19.49/mo

4.2.17 VR, AR, and Immersive Tech

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-VR-2001	ImmerseOne VR Headset, Standalone	\$399.99	\$519.99
TM-VR-2005	ImmerseOne Controller Pair	\$79.99	\$104.99
TM-VR-2010	ImmerseOne Wireless Adapter	\$59.99	\$78.99

4.2.18 Health Monitoring Devices

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-HLT-2101	VitalCheck Smart Blood Pressure Monitor	\$59.99	\$78.99
TM-HLT-2105	VitalCheck Smart Body Scale	\$44.99	\$58.99
TM-HLT-2110	VitalCheck Pulse Oximeter	\$29.99	\$38.99
TM-HLT-2115	SleepSense Sleep Tracking Mat	\$89.99	\$116.99

4.2.19 Projectors and Home Theater

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-PRJ-2201	BeamCast Portable Mini Projector	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-PRJ-2205	BeamCast 4K Home Theater Projector	\$899.99	\$1,169.99
TM-PRJ-2210	SoundBar Elite 5.1 Home Theater System	\$399.99	\$519.99

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-PRJ-2215	SoundBar Compact 2.1 System	\$149.99	\$194.99
TM-PRJ-2220	Projector Screen, 120-inch Motorized	\$249.99	\$324.99

4.2.20 Pet Tech

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-PET-2301	FeedTime Automatic Pet Feeder	\$79.99	\$104.99
TM-PET-2305	PawCam Pet Monitoring Camera	\$99.99	\$129.99
TM-PET-2310	TrackTag GPS Pet Collar	\$49.99	\$64.99

4.2.21 Micromobility

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-MOB-2401	RollEasy Electric Kick Scooter	\$449.99	\$584.99
TM-MOB-2405	RollEasy Electric Bike, City Model	\$1,199.99	\$1,559.99
TM-MOB-2410	RollEasy Replacement Battery Pack	\$199.99	\$259.99
TM-MOB-2415	RollEasy Smart Helmet with Turn Signals	\$89.99	\$116.99

4.2.22 3D Printing

SKU	Product	USD Price	CAD Price
TM-3DP-2501	FormLayer Entry 3D Printer	\$299.99	\$389.99
TM-3DP-2505	FormLayer Pro Resin 3D Printer	\$549.99	\$714.99
TM-3DP-2510	FormLayer PLA Filament, 1kg Spool	\$24.99	\$32.99

4.7 Popular Bundle Packages

Bundle Name	Included Items	Bundle Price	Individual Total	Savings
Home Theater Starter	55" Vision Smart TV + SoundBar Compact 2.1	\$599.99	\$649.98	\$49.99
Smart Entry Bundle	SmartLock Pro + GuardCam Video Doorbell + HomeHub	\$379.99	\$429.97	\$49.98
Creator Bundle	CaptureOne Camera Body + 18-55mm Kit Lens	\$1,099.99	\$1,149.98	\$49.99
Work-From-Home Bundle	AeroBook 14" Laptop + ClearView 27" Monitor + TypeFlow Keyboard	\$1,169.99	\$1,249.97	\$79.98
Coffee Lover Bundle	BrewMaster Espresso Machine + BlendPro Blender	\$319.99	\$339.98	\$19.99

The product listings above represent a representative sample of TechMart's active catalog and are intended to illustrate pricing structure and SKU conventions for knowledge base and RAG purposes. TechMart's full

catalog contains several thousand active SKUs across these same categories, with new products added and discontinued products retired on a rolling basis throughout the year. Discontinued SKUs remain viewable in a customer's order history for warranty and return purposes even after they are removed from the active storefront.

4.8 Product Category Overviews

The following overviews describe each major product category carried by TechMart Electronics, intended to help the Product Agent and Billing Agent understand what falls within each category when a customer's question references pricing, warranty terms, or return rules "for my headphones" or "for my TV" without naming a specific SKU.

Audio

TechMart's audio lineup spans over-ear and in-ear headphones, true wireless earbuds, portable and home Bluetooth speakers, and USB microphones aimed at podcasters and streamers. Most audio products carry a standard 1-year manufacturer warranty and fall under the standard 30-day return window, with hygiene-seal requirements applying specifically to in-ear products for hygiene reasons.

Computing Accessories

This category covers keyboards, mice, monitors, docking stations, USB hubs, and charging accessories designed to complement laptops and desktops. Computing accessories are generally lightweight to ship and have no restocking fee under normal return conditions.

Smart Home

TechMart's smart home range includes security cameras, video doorbells, smart locks, thermostats, and the HomeHub central controller that ties these devices together into a single app experience. Smart home devices must be factory-reset and unpaired from any TechMart or third-party account before being returned, to protect the next customer's privacy and allow the device to be resold as open-box inventory if applicable.

Televisions and Displays

TechMart Vision televisions range from 43-inch entry-level 4K models to 75-inch QLED flagship models. Because large TVs are fragile in transit, TechMart requires the original box for returns of 55-inch and larger models to avoid a restocking fee, and recommends customers keep packaging for at least the first 30 days after delivery.

Major Appliances

Refrigerators, washers, dryers, ranges, and dishwashers are delivered and, where applicable, installed by a TechMart delivery partner. Returns of major appliances are handled via scheduled pickup rather than customer drop-off or mail return, and a 10% restocking fee applies if the unit has already been installed and used.

Gaming

TechMart's gaming category includes controllers, racing wheels, gaming chairs, high-refresh-rate monitors, gaming headsets, and external storage optimized for game libraries. Gaming peripherals follow the standard 30-day return policy; gaming chairs, due to size, are returned via a scheduled pickup similar to major appliances if the original packaging is no longer available.

Wearables

The PulseFit and TrackBand families provide smartwatches and fitness trackers, including a dedicated kids' watch model with parental controls. Wearables must have any hygiene-seal packaging intact for the standard no-restocking-fee return, similar to in-ear audio products.

Cameras and Drones

This category includes mirrorless cameras, lenses, action cameras, and consumer drones. Drones are subject to standard consumer electronics return rules, though a missing battery, remote, or propeller set at the time of return may result in a 10% restocking fee if the component cannot be located and added back before the return is processed.

Tablets, E-Readers, and Laptops

SlateBook tablets, PageTurn e-readers, and AeroBook laptops make up TechMart's computing hardware line. These products carry a 1-year manufacturer warranty as standard, extendable to 2 years automatically for TechMart Plus Pro members.

Car Electronics

DriveLink and SafeView products bring wireless CarPlay/Android Auto adapters, dash cams, and backup camera kits to older vehicles. Because these products are often professionally installed, TechMart recommends confirming compatibility with a vehicle's make and model before installation, since installation labor performed by a third party is not refundable even if the product itself is returned.

Small Kitchen Appliances

Coffee makers, espresso machines, air fryers, blenders, multi-cookers, and toasters make up this fast-moving category. Kitchen appliances follow the standard 30-day return policy and require the item to be free of food residue and thoroughly cleaned before return processing, consistent with general hygiene handling practices for the returns facility.

Personal Care Electronics

Shavers, trimmers, hair dryers, and electric toothbrushes fall under personal care electronics, which similarly require intact hygiene-seal packaging for a no-fee standard return, given the personal nature of these products.

Networking and Home Office

Wi-Fi routers, mesh systems, range extenders, printers, monitor arms, and standing desk converters support home and small-office setups. Printers are tested for print quality upon return if opened, and any included starter ink or toner cartridges are expected to be returned with the unit.

Robot Vacuums and Home Cleaning

SweepBot robot vacuums and AirPure air purifiers fall in this category. Robot vacuums must have their onboard dustbin emptied and cleaned before return processing for sanitary handling at the returns facility.

Smart Lighting

GlowSet smart bulbs, light strips, dimmer switches, and outdoor floodlights make up TechMart's smart lighting range, generally low-cost, lightweight items that fall under the standard return policy with no restocking fee.

Home Security Systems

The GuardSuite family provides do-it-yourself security kits with optional professional monitoring, described further in Chapter 3. Sensors and starter kits follow the standard return policy; the monitoring subscription itself is cancellable independent of returning the hardware.

VR, AR, and Immersive Tech

ImmerseOne VR headsets and accessories are returnable within the standard window provided the foam facial interface, which is a hygiene-sensitive component, has not been removed from its original hygienic packaging seal.

Health Monitoring Devices

VitalCheck and SleepSense products help customers track blood pressure, weight, oxygen levels, and sleep patterns. These are not FDA-cleared medical devices and are marketed for general wellness tracking; this distinction is stated on every relevant product page and does not affect standard return and warranty handling.

Projectors and Home Theater

BeamCast projectors and SoundBar audio systems round out TechMart's home theater offerings alongside its televisions. Bulb-based projector models have a separate, shorter warranty period specifically for the projector lamp component, which is considered a consumable part.

Pet Tech

FeedTime feeders, PawCam monitors, and TrackTag GPS collars are TechMart's pet technology offerings, all following the standard 30-day return policy.

Micromobility

RollEasy scooters and e-bikes are shipped via freight carrier due to size and battery content, and follow a scheduled-pickup return process similar to major appliances rather than a mailed return label.

3D Printing

FormLayer 3D printers and consumables serve hobbyist and small-business customers. Opened filament spools are not returnable once the seal is broken, similar to other consumable goods, but unopened spools follow the standard return policy.

4.3 Discounts and Promotions

4.3.1 Promo Codes

Promotional discount codes may be entered at checkout in the "Promo Code" field. Only one promo code may be applied per order; TechMart does not permit stacking multiple percentage-based promo codes. Promo codes may be restricted by category, minimum order value, customer eligibility (e.g., new customers only), or expiration date. Expired or invalid codes display an explanatory message at checkout rather than silently failing.

4.3.2 TechMart Plus Member Pricing

Certain items display a separate, lower "Member Price" visible only to signed-in TechMart Plus subscribers, typically 5–10% below the standard listed price. Member pricing is automatically applied at checkout for active Plus members and cannot be combined with a promo code that is explicitly marked as "non-stackable with Member Pricing."

4.3.3 Seasonal Sales Events

- Spring Refresh Sale — early April, typically 10–20% off smart home and audio categories.
- Summer Cooling Sale — mid-June, appliance-focused, up to 25% off select refrigerators and air conditioners.
- Back-to-School Sale — late August, computing accessories and monitors.
- TechMart Deal Days — Black Friday through Cyber Monday, TechMart's largest annual sale across all categories.
- Holiday Gift Sale — December, gift-focused bundles and doorbuster pricing on audio and TV categories.

4.4 Price Match Guarantee

TechMart will match the current listed price of an identical, in-stock item (same SKU, brand, and model) sold by a major authorized retailer, within 14 days of purchase. Price match requests must be submitted through Account > Order History > Request Price Match, along with a link or screenshot of the competitor's listing. TechMart does not price match marketplace sellers (such as third-party sellers on multi-vendor platforms), auction sites, clearance/liquidation pricing, membership-club pricing (e.g., warehouse club exclusive pricing), or prices from outside the United States/Canada. Approved price match adjustments are issued as a partial refund to the original payment method within 5–7 business days.

4.5 Bundle Pricing

TechMart offers bundle discounts when specific complementary products are purchased together in a single order, such as a smart TV with a soundbar, or a smart lock with a video doorbell and HomeHub controller. Bundle discounts are applied automatically in the shopping cart once all qualifying items are added and are shown as a single line-item discount labeled "Bundle Savings" on the invoice.

4.6 Regional Pricing Notes (US vs. Canada)

Canadian pricing is generally higher than the direct USD-to-CAD currency conversion would suggest. This reflects import duties, cross-border shipping and warehousing costs, and Canadian regulatory compliance costs (such as CSA safety certification for electrical products) that are unique to the Canadian market. TechMart reviews Canadian pricing quarterly and adjusts it independently of short-term currency exchange rate fluctuations, meaning Canadian prices do not change daily even though the CAD/USD exchange rate does.

5. Refund, Return & Cancellation Policy

This chapter sets out TechMart Electronics' policy for returns, refunds, exchanges, and order cancellations across product categories, along with special rules for subscriptions, gift purchases, and open-box or clearance items.

5.1 Standard Return Window

Most products purchased from TechMart Electronics, whether online or in-store, may be returned within **30 calendar days** of the delivery date (online orders) or purchase date (in-store orders) for a full refund to the original payment method, provided the item is in its original condition with all included accessories, manuals, and packaging. TechMart Plus Pro members receive an **extended 60-day return window** as one of their membership benefits, and TechMart Plus Basic and Family members receive a **90-day extended return window** as noted in Chapter 3.

5.2 Category-Specific Return Rules

Category	Return Window	Condition Requirements	Restocking Fee
Audio (headphones, speakers)	30 days (standard)	Original packaging; hygiene seal intact for earbuds	15% for earbuds/in-ear items
Computing accessories	30 days (standard)	No physical damage; all cables/adapters included	None
Smart home devices	30 days (standard)	Device factory-reset and unpaired from any home	None
Televisions ≥ 55 inch	30 days (standard)	Original box required due to shipping fragility	15% if original box is missing
Major appliances	30 days (standard)	Uninstalled, unused; installed appliances subject to inspection	10% if inspected
Software & digital licenses	Non-refundable once activated	N/A	N/A
Gift cards	Non-refundable, non-returnable	N/A	N/A
Custom/special-order items	Non-returnable unless defective	N/A	N/A

5.3 How to Initiate a Return

Customers initiate a return through Account > Order History > Start a Return, selecting the item and a reason for return. TechMart generates a prepaid return shipping label for eligible online orders at no cost to the customer within the standard return window; returns initiated after the standard window but within a membership-extended window may require the customer to cover return shipping, depending on the reason selected. In-store purchases may be returned to any TechMart retail location regardless of which location the item was originally purchased from.

5.4 Refund Timing and Method

Once a returned item is received and inspected at a TechMart returns facility (typically within 3–5 business days of drop-off), a refund is issued to the original payment method. Refund processing times vary by payment method: credit and debit card refunds typically post within 3–7 business days; PayPal and digital wallet refunds typically post within 1–3 business days; ACH and Interac e-Transfer refunds typically take 5–10 business days; and refunds to an expired or closed card are automatically converted to TechMart store credit. In-store returns with a receipt are refunded immediately at the register to the original payment method, or as cash for original cash purchases.

For subscription cancellations, monthly plans are not refunded for the remainder of an already-paid period, since the cancellation simply prevents future renewal. Annual plan cancellations requested within the first 14 days of the annual billing cycle are eligible for a full refund; cancellations requested after day 14 receive a prorated refund based on unused full months remaining in the annual term, minus a \$10 early-cancellation processing fee.

5.5 Defective, Damaged, or Incorrect Items

If an item arrives defective, damaged in transit, or different from what was ordered, TechMart covers return shipping in full and offers the customer a choice between a full refund, a free replacement unit, or an exchange for a different product of equal value. Defective-item claims should be reported within 7 days of delivery for fastest processing, though TechMart's standard 30-day (or membership-extended) window still applies for claims reported later. Products that fail after the return window but within the manufacturer's or TechMart's warranty period are handled under the warranty claims process rather than the returns process (Section 5.8).

5.6 Open-Box, Clearance, and Final Sale Items

Open-box items (previously returned, inspected, and resold at a discount) and clearance-tagged items are marked as **Final Sale** at checkout and are not eligible for standard return or refund, except in cases where the item is found to be defective upon arrival, in which case standard defective-item handling under Section 5.5 applies. Open-box and clearance items still carry a minimum 90-day manufacturer defect warranty unless explicitly noted otherwise on the product page.

5.7 Order Cancellations Before Shipment

Orders may be cancelled free of charge at any point before they enter the "Preparing for Shipment" status, which can be checked under Account > Order History. Once an order has moved to "Preparing for Shipment" or later, it can no longer be cancelled directly; instead, the customer may refuse delivery or initiate a standard return once the item arrives. Orders paid via ACH or Interac e-Transfer that are cancelled before the transfer clears are simply not charged; if the transfer has already cleared, the refund follows the standard timelines in Section 5.4.

5.8 Warranty Claims (Distinct From Returns)

TechMart provides a standard 1-year manufacturer warranty on most electronics and a 2-year warranty on major appliances, covering manufacturing defects but not accidental damage, misuse, or normal wear.

TechMart Plus Pro members receive an automatic warranty extension to 2 years on electronics and 3 years on appliances at no extra cost. Customers who purchased optional Warranty+ coverage (Chapter 3, Section 3.2.2) additionally receive accidental damage protection for the duration of that plan. Warranty claims are submitted through Account > Order History > Start a Warranty Claim and typically result in a free repair or replacement rather than a cash refund, at TechMart's discretion, unless a repair or replacement is not feasible.

5.9 Gift Returns

Items received as a gift can be returned using the gift receipt (available digitally via a link shared by the purchaser, or physically for in-store gift receipts) without revealing the original purchase price to the recipient. Gift returns are issued as TechMart store credit rather than a refund to the original purchaser's payment method, since the recipient is not the original payer. Gifts returned without any receipt may be exchanged for store credit at TechMart's current selling price, subject to manager approval and identity verification.

5.11 Return Process by Channel

5.11.1 Returning an Online Order by Mail

- Start the return under Account > Order History > Start a Return and select a reason.
- Print the prepaid return label emailed to you, or use the QR code option to drop off without printing at participating carrier locations.
- Pack the item securely with all original accessories and packaging materials.
- Drop off within 14 days of generating the label; labels expire after 14 days and must be regenerated if unused.
- Track the return under Account > Order History > Return Status; refund issues 3–5 business days after the item is received at the returns facility.

5.11.2 Returning to a TechMart Store

- Bring the item and, if available, the receipt or order confirmation email (a receipt lookup by phone number or email is also available at the register).
- A store associate inspects the item and processes the refund on the spot to the original payment method, or as store credit for gift/no-receipt returns.
- In-store returns of online orders are accepted at any location and do not require the original shipping box.

5.11.3 Returning a Large Appliance

Major appliances (refrigerators, washers, dryers, ranges, dishwashers) are returned via scheduled pickup rather than a mailed label, due to size and weight. Customers schedule a pickup window under Account > Order History > Schedule Appliance Return; a TechMart delivery partner retrieves the unit, and refund processing begins once the unit passes an on-site condition check at pickup, rather than waiting for it to

reach a central facility.

5.12 Restocking Fees — Full Reference

Condition	Restocking Fee
Item returned in original, unopened packaging within window	None
Item opened but undamaged, all accessories included	None (standard categories)
TV 55" or larger returned without original box	15% of item price
Major appliance installed/used before return	10% of item price
Drone or camera missing original case/accessories	10% of item price
Item returned with missing manuals or cables only	None — item is still returnable, but replacement of missing accessories

5.13 Holiday Extended Return Window

Purchases made between November 1 and December 24 each year are eligible for an extended return window through January 24 of the following year, regardless of the standard 30/60/90-day window that would otherwise apply, to accommodate gift-giving during the holiday season. This extension applies automatically and does not need to be requested; it is reflected directly in Account > Order History for eligible orders.

5.14 State and Provincial Consumer Protection Notes

TechMart's return policy meets or exceeds the minimum requirements of applicable state and provincial consumer protection statutes. Some jurisdictions impose additional requirements that TechMart follows specifically in those regions: for example, certain U.S. states require that a store's return policy be conspicuously posted at the point of sale, which TechMart satisfies through signage at all 42 retail locations and a persistent link to this policy in the checkout footer. Quebec's Consumer Protection Act imposes specific disclosure requirements for distance contracts, which TechMart addresses through the order confirmation email sent for every purchase made from the Canadian storefront.

5.15 Illustrative Refund Scenarios

- **Scenario A:** A customer buys headphones on March 1 and returns them, unopened, on March 20. Outcome: full refund to original card, no restocking fee, processed within 3–7 business days of TechMart receiving the return.
- **Scenario B:** A TechMart Plus Pro member buys a monitor on March 1 and decides to return it on April 25 (day 55). Outcome: still within the 60-day Plus Pro window, so a full refund applies.
- **Scenario C:** A customer's 65-inch TV arrives with a cracked screen. Outcome: treated as a defective/damaged item; free return shipping, and the customer may choose a full refund, free replacement, or exchange rather than following standard return timelines.

- **Scenario D:** A customer buys an open-box laptop marked Final Sale and it works as described but they simply changed their mind. Outcome: not eligible for return, since Final Sale items are excluded from the standard return policy.
- **Scenario E:** A customer cancels a TechMart Plus annual plan 40 days into a 365-day term. Outcome: prorated refund for the unused full months remaining, minus the \$10 early-cancellation processing fee.
- **Scenario F:** A customer receives a smart speaker as a birthday gift and wants to return it for a different color. Outcome: using the gift receipt, they receive TechMart store credit for the item's price, redeemable toward the replacement.

5.16 International and Cross-Border Purchases

TechMart does not currently ship or sell outside the United States and Canada, and does not accept returns mailed from outside these two countries. Customers who relocate internationally after a purchase should contact Billing Support to discuss options, which are evaluated on a case-by-case basis and may include store credit in lieu of a physical return if return shipping is not feasible.

Scenario	Outcome
Standard item, within 30 days, original condition	Full refund to original payment method
TechMart Plus Pro member, within 60 days	Full refund to original payment method
Item defective on arrival	Full refund, free replacement, or exchange — customer's choice; free return shipping
Open-box/clearance item, not defective	Not eligible for return (Final Sale)
Order cancelled before shipment	Full refund / no charge, processed immediately
Monthly subscription cancelled mid-cycle	No partial refund; access continues until cycle ends
Annual subscription cancelled within 14 days	Full refund
Annual subscription cancelled after 14 days	Prorated refund minus \$10 processing fee
Gift returned with gift receipt	TechMart store credit issued to recipient
Product failure after return window but within warranty	Free repair or replacement under warranty claim

6. Billing Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

This chapter compiles the most common billing questions submitted to TechMart Electronics customer support, organized by topic, along with concise official answers. This FAQ is intended to ground the FAQ Agent and Billing Agent for quick, accurate responses to routine questions.

Payment Methods

What payment methods does TechMart accept online?

TechMart accepts Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover, Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, Shop Pay, ACH bank transfer (US, orders over \$500), Interac e-Transfer (Canada, orders up to CAD \$5,000), TechMart gift cards, store credit, and the TechMart Store Credit Card.

Why was my card declined even though I have enough funds?

Declines can occur due to an incorrect billing ZIP/postal code, a card not enabled for online purchases, or a temporary fraud hold placed by your bank. TechMart does not receive the specific decline reason from the bank, so we recommend contacting your card issuer directly or trying an alternate payment method.

Can I save more than one payment method to my account?

Yes. You can save up to five payment methods under Account Settings > Payment Methods and choose which one to use at checkout.

What is the small \$1 charge I see after adding a new card?

This is a temporary authorization hold used to verify the card is valid. It is not an actual charge and automatically releases within 1–3 business days.

Does TechMart charge a fee for using PayPal or Apple Pay?

No, TechMart does not add any surcharge for using digital wallets. Any foreign transaction fee you see would come from your card issuer, not TechMart.

Can I pay for my TechMart order in installments?

Yes, orders between \$50 and \$3,000 are eligible for 4 interest-free installments through TechMart's BNPL partner, PayLater Financial, selectable at checkout.

Is it safe to store my card with TechMart?

Yes. TechMart is PCI-DSS Level 1 certified and stores only a secure token, never your full card number, on its servers.

Invoices

Where can I find my invoice or receipt?

All invoices are available under Account > Order History > Invoices as downloadable PDFs, and are also emailed within 5 minutes of purchase or subscription renewal.

My invoice shows the wrong tax amount. What do I do?

Submit a correction request via Account > Order History > Report an Issue. Billing Operations reviews requests within 2 business days and issues a credit memo if the correction is approved.

Can TechMart send invoices to my company's accounts payable email?

Yes, TechMart Business Accounts can set a separate accounts-payable email address and enable consolidated monthly invoicing rather than per-order invoices.

What does the invoice number format mean?

Standard order invoices use TM-YYYY-XXXXXXX, subscription renewal invoices use TM-SUB-YYYY-XXXXXXX, and credit memos use TM-CM-YYYY-XXXXXXX, always referencing the original invoice.

Can I get a Net-30 invoice instead of paying immediately?

Net-30 payment terms are available to approved TechMart Business Accounts, subject to a credit approval process.

I never received my invoice email — where is it?

Check spam/promotions folders first. If it's still missing after 24 hours, download it directly from Account > Order History, which is always up to date.

Subscriptions

How do I cancel my TechMart Plus membership?

Go to Account > Membership > Manage Subscription > Cancel. Cancellation takes effect at the end of your current paid billing cycle.

Will I be charged automatically after my free trial ends?

Yes. If you don't cancel before the 30-day trial ends, your account converts to a paid TechMart Plus Pro monthly subscription and the first charge occurs on day 31.

Can I get a refund if I forgot to cancel before renewal?

Monthly renewals are not refunded for the current cycle. Annual renewals cancelled within 14 days of the charge are eligible for a full refund; after 14 days, a prorated refund minus a \$10 fee applies.

What happens if my subscription payment fails?

TechMart retries the charge on day 1, day 3, and day 7. If all retries fail, there is a 7-day grace period with benefits still active, after which the subscription is suspended until payment is updated.

Can I pause my TechMart Plus membership instead of cancelling?

TechMart Plus Pro and Family members can pause for up to 3 months per calendar year with no charges during the pause.

Does upgrading my plan charge me immediately?

Yes, upgrades take effect immediately and you're charged a prorated amount for the rest of the current billing cycle.

Does downgrading give me a refund for the difference?

No, downgrades take effect at the start of your next billing cycle, and there is no partial refund for the current cycle.

Pricing

Why is the Canadian price higher than the US price times the exchange rate?

Canadian pricing reflects import duties, cross-border logistics, and Canadian regulatory compliance costs, and is reviewed quarterly independent of daily currency fluctuations.

Does TechMart price match other retailers?

Yes, for identical in-stock items from major authorized retailers, within 14 days of purchase. Marketplace sellers, auction sites, clearance pricing, and warehouse-club exclusive pricing are excluded.

Can I use two promo codes on one order?

No, only one promo code can be applied per order.

Do TechMart Plus members get lower prices automatically?

Yes, eligible items show a separate Member Price that is automatically applied at checkout for signed-in Plus members.

If a price drops after I order, can I get the difference refunded?

The price shown at checkout is the price you pay; TechMart does not automatically refund later price drops, though you may be eligible for a price match request within 14 days if a competitor also has the lower price.

Refunds & Returns

How long do I have to return an item?

Standard customers have 30 days from delivery. TechMart Plus Pro members get 60 days, and Plus Basic/Family members get 90 days.

How long does a refund take to appear on my card?

Typically 3–7 business days after the returned item is received and inspected, though this depends on your card issuer's own posting time.

Is return shipping free?

Yes, for eligible returns within the standard return window, TechMart provides a free prepaid return label.

What if my item arrives damaged?

Report it and choose a full refund, free replacement, or exchange. Return shipping is free and TechMart aims to resolve defective-item claims quickly, especially if reported within 7 days of delivery.

Can I return an open-box or clearance item?

These are marked Final Sale and are not eligible for standard return unless the item is defective.

What happens if I don't have the original packaging for a TV return?

A 15% restocking fee applies to televisions 55 inches and larger returned without their original box.

Can I return something I got as a gift?

Yes, using the gift receipt. Gift returns are issued as TechMart store credit rather than a refund to the original purchaser.

What's the difference between a return and a warranty claim?

A return is for items still within the standard return window. A warranty claim applies after the return window has passed but while the product is still within its warranty period, and typically results in a repair or replacement rather than a refund.

General Billing

Who do I contact for a billing issue?

TechMart Billing Support is available at 1-800-555-0199 or billing@techmart-electronics.example, Monday–Saturday 7:00 AM–11:00 PM CT and Sunday 9:00 AM–9:00 PM CT.

Can I change my billing address after placing an order?

The billing address on an already-placed order cannot be changed, but you can update it in Account Settings for future orders.

Does TechMart accept cash in stores?

Yes, at US locations, up to \$2,000 per transaction. Canadian stores accept Interac Debit but not cash for online-linked purchases at self-checkout.

Do TechMart gift cards expire?

No, TechMart gift cards and store credit never expire and carry no maintenance fees.

How do I apply for the TechMart Store Credit Card?

You can apply at checkout or under Account > Payment Methods > Apply for TechMart Card. Approval and financing terms are determined by the issuing bank, Northgate Bank, not by TechMart directly.

Taxes

Why did my tax amount change between when I added the item to my cart and checkout?

Tax is calculated based on your shipping address, which is only confirmed at checkout. Adding an address, changing it, or applying a promo code can all change the final tax calculation shown at checkout.

I'm a nonprofit organization — can I avoid paying sales tax?

Yes, submit a valid tax-exemption certificate under Account Settings > Tax Exemption. Approval takes 3–5 business days and applies to future orders only, not retroactively.

Why was I charged GST and PST separately on my Canadian order?

Some provinces, like British Columbia and Saskatchewan, apply GST and PST as two separate taxes rather than a single combined HST, which is why both appear as separate line items on your invoice.

Does TechMart charge tax on shipping fees?

In most jurisdictions, yes, shipping is taxed the same as the merchandise it accompanies, in accordance with local tax rules. Free shipping (e.g. via TechMart Plus) has no shipping charge and therefore no additional shipping tax.

Store Credit & Gift Cards

How do I check my TechMart gift card balance?

Go to Account Settings > Gift Cards, or check balance without an account at techmart-electronics.example/giftcard-balance using the card number and PIN.

Can I combine a gift card with a credit card on the same order?

Yes, gift card balance is applied first, and any remaining amount is charged to your selected payment method.

I received store credit from a return — where do I find it?

Store credit is automatically shown and applied at checkout for signed-in accounts, and is also visible under Account Settings > Gift Cards & Store Credit.

Can store credit be transferred to another TechMart account?

No, store credit and gift card balances are tied to the account or card they were issued to and cannot be transferred, except when explicitly gifted as a new digital gift card purchase.

Business Accounts

How do I set up a TechMart Business Account?

Apply at techmart-electronics.example/business with your business tax ID; approval for standard purchasing typically takes 1–2 business days, while Net-30 credit approval can take up to 5 business days.

Can multiple employees check out using one company payment method?

Yes, Business Accounts support multiple authorized users with a shared default payment method, configurable under Account > Business Settings > Users.

Does TechMart offer volume discounts for bulk orders?

Yes, orders of 10 or more identical units may qualify for volume pricing; request a quote through your Business Account dashboard or by contacting a TechMart Business sales representative.

Shipping-Related Billing

Why was I charged for shipping when I thought it was free?

Free shipping applies to orders over \$35 for non-members, or all orders for TechMart Plus members. Oversized items like major appliances and micromobility products may carry a separate delivery fee regardless of membership, shown clearly before checkout.

Can I get a shipping refund if my package arrives late?

If a guaranteed expedited shipping option (such as 2-day shipping) is not met, TechMart automatically refunds the shipping fee for that order; standard shipping does not carry a speed guarantee.

I was charged twice for shipping on a split shipment — is that correct?

Orders with items shipping from different fulfillment centers may arrive in separate packages, but TechMart charges shipping once per order, not per package, unless the customer selected expedited shipping on an item added after the initial order was already placed.

Does returning an item refund the original shipping fee I paid?

Original shipping fees are non-refundable for standard change-of-mind returns, but are fully refunded when the return is due to a TechMart error, such as a defective or incorrect item.

Account & Security

Someone made a purchase on my account that I didn't authorize — what do I do?

Contact Billing Support immediately at 1-800-555-0199; TechMart's Trust & Fraud Prevention team will freeze further charges on the account, investigate the transaction, and issue a refund if unauthorized use is confirmed.

Why did TechMart ask me to re-verify my identity before a large purchase?

High-value orders or orders that differ significantly from a customer's typical purchase pattern may trigger an additional identity confirmation step as part of TechMart's fraud prevention measures.

Can I set up purchase approval limits for my teenager's linked account?

Yes, TechMart Plus Family accounts allow the primary subscriber to set a per-order spending limit for linked family members under Account > Family Members > Spending Controls.

How do I remove a payment method I no longer use?

Go to Account Settings > Payment Methods, select the method, and choose Remove. If it's tied to an active subscription, you'll be prompted to choose a replacement first.

Warranty Billing Questions

Does filing a warranty claim cost anything?

No, warranty claims for manufacturing defects within the covered period are free; TechMart covers return shipping for the defective unit and shipping for the repaired or replacement unit.

Is accidental damage covered under the standard warranty?

No, the standard manufacturer warranty covers defects only. Accidental damage is covered only if the customer purchased optional Warranty+ coverage at checkout, described in Chapter 3.

My product broke just after the standard warranty expired — can anything be done?

TechMart Plus Pro members automatically receive extended warranty coverage (2 years on electronics, 3 years on appliances), which may still cover the product depending on original purchase date; non-members can contact Billing Support to check for any active recall or goodwill exception.

How is a warranty repair paid for if it's approved?

Approved warranty repairs are performed at no cost to the customer; no payment method is charged for parts or labor covered under warranty.

Edge Cases & Special Situations

I moved from the US to Canada — can I transfer my TechMart Plus membership to the Canadian storefront?

TechMart Plus memberships are tied to a single country's storefront due to differing pricing and currency; contact Billing Support to cancel the US membership and start a new Canadian membership, often with a starter discount offered as a courtesy.

My card was reissued with a new number after fraud on my bank's side — will my subscription still renew?

If TechMart's payment partner's automatic card updater service does not pick up the new number, the renewal will fail and follow the standard retry and grace period process; updating the new card manually avoids any interruption.

Can I get a refund if I no longer have the item because it was lost or stolen after delivery?

Refunds require the item to be returned; a lost or stolen post-delivery item is not eligible for a standard refund, though customers should also file a claim with the shipping carrier and, where applicable, their homeowner's or renter's insurance.

What happens to my subscription if TechMart discontinues a plan tier?

Existing subscribers on a discontinued tier are typically grandfathered at their current price and benefits for a minimum of 12 months, with advance email notice before any required migration to a current plan.

I was double-billed because I checked out twice by accident — what happens?

Duplicate orders placed within a short window are flagged by TechMart's order system for review; if confirmed as an accidental duplicate, the duplicate order is cancelled and refunded automatically, typically within 1 business day.

End of TechMart Electronics Billing Knowledge Base. This document is fictional and created for educational use in a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) capstone project.

7. Appendix

7.1 Glossary of Billing Terms

Authorization Hold — A temporary reservation of funds on a card to verify validity; not an actual charge.

Chargeback — A payment reversal initiated by a customer through their card issuer rather than directly with TechMart.

Credit Memo — A document issued to correct a prior invoice, referencing the original invoice number.

Grace Period — The 7-day window after a failed subscription payment during which benefits remain active.

Interchange Fee — A fee paid between banks for card transaction processing, set by card networks, not TechMart.

Member Price — A discounted price visible only to signed-in TechMart Plus subscribers.

Net-30 — A business payment term requiring invoice payment within 30 calendar days of the invoice date.

Proration — Calculating a partial charge or refund based on the fraction of a billing period used or remaining.

PCI-DSS — Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard, a security certification for handling card data.

SKU — Stock Keeping Unit — TechMart's unique product identifier code.

Store Credit — A non-expiring account balance usable toward future TechMart purchases.

Tokenization — Replacing a card number with a secure reference so the real number is never stored directly.

3-D Secure (3DS2) — An additional card authentication step, such as a one-time code, required by some banks.

7.2 Support Escalation Matrix

Issue Type	First Point of Contact	Escalation Path
Routine billing question	AI Billing Agent / FAQ Agent	Human Billing Support agent
Disputed charge / invoice correction	Human Billing Support agent	Billing Operations review team
Suspected fraud on account	Human Billing Support agent	Trust & Fraud Prevention team
Denied correction request	Billing Operations	Billing Support supervisor
Net-30 business credit issue	Business Account manager	Business Billing Operations
Chargeback received	Automated (Trust & Fraud Prevention)	Card network dispute response
Warranty claim disagreement	Warranty & Returns team	Warranty Operations supervisor

7.3 Contact Directory

Department	Phone	Email
General Customer Support	1-800-555-0182	support@techmart-electronics.example
Billing Support	1-800-555-0199	billing@techmart-electronics.example
Warranty & Returns	1-800-555-0155	warranty@techmart-electronics.example
Business Accounts	1-800-555-0177	business@techmart-electronics.example
Trust & Fraud Prevention	1-800-555-0166	fraud@techmart-electronics.example
Media & Press	1-800-555-0111	press@techmart-electronics.example

7.4 Document Change Log

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
4.2	January 1, 2026	Updated pricing catalog; added TechMart Plus Business tier; refreshed tax tables.
4.1	August 15, 2025	Extended holiday return window language; added family plan linking details.
4.0	March 1, 2025	Introduced TechMart Plus Pro tier and Warranty+ auto-renew plans.
3.2	October 10, 2024	Added Interac e-Transfer support for Canadian storefront.
3.1	May 5, 2024	Clarified restocking fee rules for large TVs and appliances.
3.0	January 1, 2024	Major rewrite establishing current chapter structure.

7.5 How This Document Should Be Used for RAG

For retrieval-augmented generation pipelines, this document is designed to be split by chapter and sub-section, since each section addresses a self-contained billing topic. Recommended chunking is by heading boundary (chapter, section, or sub-section) with a chunk size of roughly 300–500 tokens, which keeps most individual policies, FAQ answers, and table rows intact within a single chunk. Tables such as the pricing catalog, tax rate reference, and restocking fee reference are good candidates for row-level or table-level chunking, since a customer question about a single product or single state's tax rate should retrieve the specific relevant row rather than the entire table. The Billing Agent should be given the Payment Methods, Invoices, and Pricing chapters as primary context; the Complaint Agent and Refund-related routing should prioritize the Refund, Return & Cancellation Policy chapter; and the FAQ Agent should prioritize Chapter 6 directly, falling back to the other chapters for questions not already covered by an existing FAQ entry.

7.6 Sample AI Billing Agent Conversations

The following illustrative transcripts show how the Billing Agent is expected to apply the policies in this document when responding to customers. These are provided as grounding examples for prompt design and evaluation, not as content to be quoted verbatim to customers.

Refund Timing Question

Customer: I returned my headphones 6 days ago and still don't see my refund.

Billing Agent: Thanks for checking in. Once a return arrives at our facility, inspection typically takes 3–5 business days, and the refund itself then takes 3–7 business days to post to a card, or 1–3 business days for PayPal or a digital wallet. Based on a 6-day timeline, your refund should already be processing or about to post. I can look up your specific return status if you share your order number.

Subscription Cancellation

Customer: Cancel my TechMart Plus, I don't use it enough.

Billing Agent: I've cancelled your TechMart Plus membership. You'll keep your current benefits through the end of your paid billing cycle on [date], and you won't be charged again after that. If you change your mind, you can resubscribe anytime from Account > Membership.

Duplicate Charge

Customer: I see two charges of \$146.15 on my card for the same order.

Billing Agent: I'm sorry for the confusion. One of those is likely a temporary authorization hold rather than a second charge — these release automatically within 1–3 business days and don't result in you being charged twice. If both charges are still showing after 5 business days, let me know and I'll escalate this to Billing Operations for a manual review.

Price Match Request

Customer: Another store has the same TV for \$50 less, can you match it?

Billing Agent: I'd be glad to check. Could you share a link or screenshot of the competitor's listing? To qualify, it needs to be the exact same SKU, in stock, and sold directly by a major authorized retailer within 14 days of your purchase. If it qualifies, I'll issue the \$50 difference back to your original payment method within 5–7 business days.

Failed Renewal Payment

Customer: I got an email saying my payment failed, but my card is fine.

Billing Agent: That can sometimes happen due to a temporary hold from your bank rather than an actual card issue. We'll automatically retry the charge on day 3 and again on day 7 if needed, so no action may be required. If you'd like, I can also help you update your payment method now to avoid waiting for the automatic retry.

7.7 Data Privacy Notes for Billing Information

Billing data collected by TechMart — including payment tokens, invoice history, and subscription records — is used solely for processing transactions, fraud prevention, customer support, and legal and tax record-keeping. TechMart does not sell billing data to third parties. Payment processing partners and tax calculation services receive only the minimum data needed to complete their function. Customers can request a copy of their billing data or request account deletion (subject to the 7-year financial record retention requirement described in Section 2.13) through Account > Privacy > Data Requests.

7.8 Frequently Referenced Policy Numbers Summary

Policy	Value
Standard return window	30 days
TechMart Plus Pro return window	60 days
TechMart Plus Basic/Family return window	90 days
Holiday extended return window	Through January 24
Failed payment retry schedule	Day 1, Day 3, Day 7
Subscription grace period	7 days after final failed retry
Free trial length (TechMart Plus Pro)	30 days
Max membership pause per year	3 months
Annual subscription full-refund window	14 days from renewal charge
Early subscription cancellation fee	\$10
Price match window	14 days from purchase
Cash payment limit in-store (US)	\$2,000 per transaction
ACH minimum order (US)	\$500
Interac e-Transfer maximum (Canada)	CAD \$5,000
BNPL eligible order range	\$50 – \$3,000
Invoice/record retention period	7 years minimum

End of Appendix and end of the TechMart Electronics Billing Knowledge Base document.